

GERD

Lower oesophageal sphincter (LES)

- A muscular ring at the junction of the oesophagus and stomach that prevents acid reflux.

Diaphragmatic crura

- Muscle fibers of the diaphragm that surround the oesophagus, aiding in its closure.

Oblique entry

- The slanted angle at which the oesophagus enters the stomach, adding a natural barrier to reflux.

Reflux oesophagitis

- Inflammation of the oesophagus due to acid reflux.

Sliding hiatus hernia

- A condition where part of the stomach pushes into the chest through the diaphragm, disrupting oesophageal functions.

Cardiomyotomy

- A surgical procedure to cut the muscles of the oesophagus to relieve difficulty in swallowing.

. Vagotomy

- Cutting of the vagus nerve to reduce stomach acid production, which may weaken the LES.

Ascites

- Accumulation of fluid in the abdominal cavity, increasing intra-abdominal pressure.

Anticholinergic drugs

- Medications that block nerve signals involved in muscle contractions and secretions, slowing gastric emptying.

Systemic sclerosis

- A rare autoimmune disease causing thickening and scarring of tissues, affecting the oesophagus.

Aminophylline

- A drug used to treat asthma that relaxes smooth muscles, reducing LES tone.

. Beta-agonists

- Medications that stimulate certain nerve receptors, used for asthma and other conditions, but relax LES.

Barrett's oesophagus

- A condition where the lining of the oesophagus changes due to chronic acid exposure, increasing cancer risk.

Odynophagia

- Painful swallowing.

Dysphagia

- Difficulty in swallowing, which can be temporary or persistent.

Aspiration pneumonia

- Lung infection caused by inhaling food, stomach acid, or saliva.

Endoscopy

- A diagnostic procedure using a flexible tube with a camera to examine the digestive tract.

Oesophagitis

- Inflammation of the oesophagus.

Barrett's mucosa

- Abnormal changes in the oesophageal lining due to acid reflux.

Biopsy

- Removal of a small tissue sample for microscopic examination.

Barium meal

- A radiological test where a patient swallows a barium solution to highlight the digestive tract on X-rays.

Bernstein test

- A diagnostic test where acid is introduced into the oesophagus to reproduce symptoms of reflux.

Ischaemic heart disease

- A condition caused by reduced blood supply to the heart.

Oesophageal motility studies

- Tests measuring muscle contractions and movement in the oesophagus.

H₂ receptor antagonists

- Medications (e.g., Cimetidine, Ranitidine) that reduce stomach acid production by blocking histamine receptors.

Proton Pump Inhibitors (PPIs)

- Drugs (e.g., Omeprazole, Pantoprazole) that block stomach acid production by inhibiting enzyme activity.

Adjunctive therapy

- Additional treatments to complement the primary therapy.

Metoclopramide/Domperidone

- Medications that enhance LES tone and speed up stomach emptying.

Dilatation

- A procedure to widen a narrowed section of the oesophagus.

Fundoplication

- A surgical procedure to wrap the stomach around the oesophagus to strengthen the LES.

Peptic ulcer

Anastomosis

- A surgical connection between two parts of the digestive system.

Meckel's diverticulum

- A congenital pouch in the ileum, which can cause ulcers or bleeding.

Submucosa

- A layer of tissue beneath the mucosa, containing blood vessels and nerves.

Helicobacter pylori

- A bacteria that infects the stomach lining, causing ulcers and inflammation.

Urease

- An enzyme produced by H. pylori that breaks down urea into ammonia, damaging the stomach lining.

NSAIDs

- Non-Steroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs like ibuprofen and aspirin that can cause stomach damage.

Cytoprotection

- The stomach's natural ability to protect its lining from acid damage.

. Zollinger-Ellison syndrome

- A condition causing excessive stomach acid production due to tumors in the pancreas or duodenum.

Pyloric sphincter

- A muscular valve controlling the flow of stomach contents into the duodenum.

Epigastrium

- The upper central part of the abdomen, just below the ribcage.

Water-brash

- Sudden excess salivation due to acid reflux.

Haematemesis

- Vomiting of blood, often due to bleeding ulcers.

Gastric outlet obstruction

- Blockage of the stomach's exit, preventing food from passing into the duodenum.

Barium meal

- A diagnostic X-ray test using barium to highlight abnormalities in the digestive tract.

Serum gastrin

- A blood test measuring gastrin hormone levels, often elevated in Zollinger-Ellison syndrome.

Urea breath test

- A non-invasive test for detecting H. pylori by measuring exhaled carbon dioxide after consuming a urea solution.

Antacids

- Medications that neutralize stomach acid to provide symptomatic relief.

Alginates

- Substances that form a protective "raft" over stomach contents, reducing acid reflux.

Parietal cells

- Cells in the stomach lining that secrete gastric acid.

Proton Pump Inhibitors (PPIs)

- Medications that block the enzyme (H⁺/K⁺ ATPase) responsible for stomach acid production.

Zollinger-Ellison syndrome

- A rare condition causing excessive stomach acid due to tumors in the pancreas or duodenum.

Prostaglandin Analogues

- Drugs that mimic prostaglandins, increasing stomach mucosal protection.

Misoprostol

- A synthetic prostaglandin used to prevent ulcers caused by NSAIDs.

Colloidal Bismuth Compounds

- Medications that coat ulcers, protecting them and also acting against *H. pylori*.

Sucralfate

- A complex salt that coats ulcers, shielding them from acid and enzymes.

H. pylori

- A bacteria that infects the stomach lining, causing ulcers.

Triple Therapy

- A treatment regimen combining a PPI, amoxicillin, and clarithromycin to eradicate *H. pylori*.

Quadruple Therapy

- An enhanced regimen adding bismuth and tetracycline to triple therapy for resistant cases.

Gastrectomy

- Surgical removal of part of the stomach.

Billroth I anastomosis

- A surgical procedure reconnecting the stomach to the duodenum after partial gastrectomy.

Vagotomy

- Surgical cutting of the vagus nerve to reduce stomach acid production.

Pyloroplasty

- Surgical enlargement of the pyloric sphincter to improve gastric emptying.

Gastroenterostomy

- A surgical procedure creating a connection between the stomach and the small intestine.

Glossitis

Glossitis

- Inflammation of the tongue, causing swelling and color changes.

Papillae

- Small, nodule-like structures on the tongue's surface responsible for taste and texture.

. Pernicious anaemia

- A type of anaemia caused by vitamin B12 deficiency due to poor absorption.

Oral lichen planus

- A chronic condition causing white patches, swelling, and sores inside the mouth.

Erythema multiforme

- A skin and mucous membrane disorder causing red spots and inflammation.

Aphthous ulcers

- Painful sores inside the mouth, also known as canker sores.

Pemphigus vulgaris

- An autoimmune disease causing blisters on the skin and mucous membranes.

Syphilis

- A sexually transmitted bacterial infection that can cause tongue lesions.

Corticosteroids

- Anti-inflammatory medications, such as prednisone, used to reduce swelling.

Antimicrobials

- Drugs that kill or inhibit the growth of bacteria, fungi, or other microorganisms.

Malabsorption syndrome

Malabsorption

- A condition where the body cannot absorb nutrients from food properly.

Chronic pancreatitis

- Long-term inflammation of the pancreas, leading to enzyme deficiency.

Cystic fibrosis

- A genetic disorder affecting the lungs and digestive system, leading to thick mucus and malabsorption.

Gastroenterostomy

- A surgical connection between the stomach and the small intestine.

Crohn's disease

- A chronic inflammatory bowel disease affecting the digestive tract.

Terminal ileum

- The last part of the small intestine responsible for bile acid absorption.

Stagnant loop syndrome

- Bacterial overgrowth in a part of the intestine due to stasis, leading to malabsorption.

Coeliac disease

- An autoimmune disorder where gluten consumption damages the small intestine lining.

Tropical sprue

- A condition causing malabsorption in people living or traveling to tropical areas.

Whipple's disease

- A rare bacterial infection that impairs nutrient absorption.

Giardiasis

- An intestinal infection caused by the parasite *Giardia lamblia*.

Radiation enteritis

- Damage to the intestine due to radiation therapy.

Lactase deficiency

- Inability to digest lactose due to low levels of the enzyme lactase.

Telangiectasia

- Small, widened blood vessels visible on the skin or mucosal surfaces.

Abetalipoproteinaemia

- A rare genetic disorder affecting fat absorption and transport.

. Lymphatic obstruction

- Blockage of the lymphatic system, leading to impaired nutrient transport.

Pericarditis

- Inflammation of the pericardium, the sac surrounding the heart.

Diabetes mellitus

- A metabolic disorder characterized by high blood sugar levels.

Hyperthyroidism

- Overactive thyroid gland producing excessive hormones.

Hypoparathyroidism

- Underactive parathyroid glands causing low calcium levels.

Emaciation

- Extreme thinness due to severe weight loss.

Pitting pedal oedema

- Swelling in the feet that leaves a dent when pressed.

Steatorrhoea

- Fatty, pale, and foul-smelling stools due to fat malabsorption.

Follicular keratosis

- A skin condition causing rough, bumpy patches.

Xerophthalmia

- Severe dryness of the eye due to vitamin A deficiency.

Keratomalacia

- Softening of the cornea due to severe vitamin A deficiency.

Tetany

- Muscle cramps and spasms due to low calcium levels.

Osteomalacia

- Softening of bones due to vitamin D deficiency.

Haemorrhagic tendencies

- Increased risk of bleeding due to vitamin K deficiency.

Angular stomatitis

- Cracks or sores at the corners of the mouth.

Cheilosis

- Cracking and scaling of the lips.

Macrocytic anaemia

- Anaemia with abnormally large red blood cells, often due to folic acid or B12 deficiency.

. Areflexia

- Absence of reflexes.

Cardiac arrhythmias

- Irregular heartbeat.

. Rickets

- Bone deformities in children due to vitamin D deficiency.

. Koilonychia

- Spoon-shaped nails often caused by iron deficiency.

Sudan III stain

- A dye used to detect fat in stool samples.

Schilling test

- A diagnostic test to identify the cause of vitamin B12 (cobalamin) deficiency.

Radio-labelled cobalamin

- Vitamin B12 tagged with a radioactive marker to track its absorption and excretion.

. Intrinsic factor

- A protein produced by the stomach necessary for vitamin B12 absorption.

Pancreatic enzymes

- Digestive proteins secreted by the pancreas, aiding nutrient breakdown.

. D-xylose test

- A test for carbohydrate absorption using a simple sugar (D-xylose).

Celiac sprue

- An autoimmune condition causing gluten intolerance and intestinal damage.

Tropical sprue

- A condition causing malabsorption, prevalent in tropical regions.

. Whipple's disease

- A rare bacterial infection affecting nutrient absorption in the intestines.

Crohn's disease

- A chronic inflammatory condition affecting the gastrointestinal tract.

Barium meal contrast radiography

- An imaging technique using barium to visualize abnormalities in the digestive system.

Steatorrhoea

- Fatty stools resulting from fat malabsorption.

Serological studies

- Blood tests to detect antibodies associated with autoimmune diseases.

Cholyl-¹⁴C-glycine

- A radioactive compound used to test bile acid metabolism.

Lactose H₂ test

- A test measuring hydrogen in breath to detect lactose intolerance or bacterial overgrowth.

Duodenal biopsy

- Sampling of tissue from the first part of the small intestine (duodenum) for diagnostic purposes.

Jejunal biopsy

- Sampling of tissue from the jejunum (middle part of the small intestine).

Cholestyramine

- A medication that binds bile acids to prevent their effects in bile acid deficiency.

Intramuscular B12

- Vitamin B12 administered through injection for effective absorption.

Electrolyte deficiency

- A lack of essential minerals like sodium, potassium, or calcium.